

The `next-intl` middleware enforces a specific locale (like `en-in`) regardless of your `next-locale` configuration usually due to automatic locale detection (Accept-Language header) or a stale cookie overriding your configuration. [next-intl +1](#)

Here are the primary reasons and solutions for this behavior:

1. Automatic Locale Detection (Accept-Language Header) [🔗](#)

By default, the middleware attempts to match the user's browser language, which might be set to English (India) `en-in`. It will prioritize this over your configured defaults if not restricted. [next-intl +3](#)

- **Solution:** Disable automatic detection to rely solely on the URL or cookie.

typescript



```
// In your routing configuration
export const routing = defineRouting({
  locales: ['en', 'de', 'en-in'],
  defaultLocale: 'en',
  localeDetection: false // Add this
});
```



2. Stale `NEXT_LOCALE` Cookie [🔗](#)

If you previously accessed the site with `en-in`, a `NEXT_LOCALE=en-in` cookie may be stored in your browser. The middleware prioritizes this cookie to ensure the user returns to their last visited locale. [next-intl +2](#)

- **Solution:** Clear your browser cookies or change the `localePrefix` to `always` to force a rewrite. [🗨️ Phrase +2](#)

3. Misconfiguration in `createMiddleware`

If the `defaultLocale` is not correctly set within the middleware function itself, it may fallback to an unexpected locale.

- **Solution:** Ensure your middleware explicitly defines the `defaultLocale`.

typescript



```
export default createMiddleware({
  locales: ['en', 'en-in'],
  defaultLocale: 'en', // Ensure this is set
  localePrefix: 'as-needed' // Optional: controls prefixing behavior
});
```



4. Locale Prefix Strategy

If using `as-needed` (default), and your configuration does not match the incoming request exactly, it may default to a specific regional locale, like `en-in`. [🔗 Phrase](#)

- **Solution:** Use `localePrefix: "always"` to make the routing explicit and stop the browser from guessing, or ensure your `pathnames` settings do not conflict. [🔗 Phrase +2](#)

If you are using `next-intl` version 3.x, ensure you are checking for `x-next-intl-locale` header in your server components if you are not using `setRequestLocale`. [🔗 GitHub](#)